

SENATE RESOLUTION 283

By Harshbarger

A RESOLUTION to honor the Dobyys-Bennett High School Band on the occasion of its 100th anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of the members of this legislative body to recognize those Tennessee ensembles that epitomize hard work and dedication and serve as exceptional ambassadors of this State; and

WHEREAS, one such renowned group of young musicians is the Dobyys-Bennett High School Band, which, since 1926, has been a source of pride for Kingsport, Sullivan County, and the State of Tennessee as one of the nation's most decorated high school music programs; and

WHEREAS, the Dobyys-Bennett Band program has a long and rich history of musical excellence and annually enrolls between 350 and 375 students, who participate in three concert bands and two marching bands; and

WHEREAS, Dobyys-Bennett Band classes meet in yearlong singletons or "skinnies" and are scheduled by instruments: woodwinds, brass, and percussion, plus color guard and music theory and technology offerings; program alumni have continued playing music at many of the finest university and conservatory band programs in America; and

WHEREAS, the Dobyys-Bennett High School Band's performance highlights include the Pasadena Tournament of Roses Parade (2002, 2007, 2014, and 2020), the Presidential Inaugural Parade of 2013, the Lord Mayor of London's Millennium Parade in 2000, the Macy's Thanksgiving Day Parade (1984, 1988, 1993, 2004, and 2011), and a featured performance at a University of Tennessee football game in 2011; and

WHEREAS, an eighteen-time winner of the Tennessee Bandmasters Association Sweepstakes Award, Dobyys-Bennett has performed on the most prestigious stages—including the American Bandmasters Association Convention, the Tennessee Music Education

Convention, the New York Wind Band Festival in Carnegie Hall, the Midwest International Band and Orchestra Clinic, the Percussive Arts International Convention, the Music for All National Concert Festival, the John Philip Sousa Foundation's "Sudler Flag of Honor," the NBA/CBDNA Southern Division Conference, and the National MENC Convention; and

WHEREAS, the Dobyns-Bennett High School Band's many highlights and trophies include the John Philip Sousa Foundation's Sudler Shield 2014, Band of America (BOA) Class AAA National Championship (2018 and 2021), BOA Grand National Finalist (2016, 2017, 2018, and 2021), BOA Grand National Semifinalist (2008, 2009, 2013, 2014, 2015, 2016, and 2017), BOA Regional Champions (2013, 2014, 2015, 2016, and 2018), and Contest of Champions Tennessee Governor's Cup (2006, 2007, and 2014); and

WHEREAS, the success of the Dobyns-Bennett High School Band over the past century has been aided in no small part by the support of band members, the community, and the administrators, faculty, and staff of Dobyns-Bennett High School; and

WHEREAS, as a result of its continued dedication to the highest expertise of musical and marching performance, the Dobyns-Bennett High School Band serves as the gold standard in the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor the members and directors of the Dobyns-Bennett High School Band, both past and present, on the occasion of the band's 100th anniversary, applaud their dedication to excellence in music and technique, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.